1.1 An analogy: taking your driving test

To illustrate some of the concepts of API security, consider an analogy from real life: taking your driving test. This may not seem at first to have very much to do with either APIs or security, but as you will see there are similarities between aspects of this story and key concepts that you will learn in this chapter.

You finish work at 5pm as usual. But today is special. Rather than going home to tend to your carnivorous plant collection and then flopping in front of the TV, you have somewhere else to be. Today you are taking your driving test.

You rush out of your office and across the park to catch a bus to the test center. As you stumble past the queue of people at the hot dog stand, you see your old friend Alice walking her pet alpaca, Horatio.

“Hi Alice!” you bellow jovially, “How’s the miniature recreation of 18th century Paris coming along?”

“Good!” she replies. “You should come and see it soon.”

She makes the universally recognized hand-gesture for “call me” and you both hurry on your separate ways.

You arrive at the test center a little hot and bothered from the crowded bus journey. If only you could drive, you think to yourself! After a short wait, the examiner comes out and introduces himself. He asks to see your learner’s driving